

Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization Using Language Identification, Named Entity Recognition, and Transformer-Based NLP

A CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT

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LEARNING

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DECLARATION

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ABSTRACT

Code-mixing, the practice of blending two or more languages within a single utterance, has become a dominant form of communication on social media, chat platforms, and other informal digital spaces, particularly among multilingual users. Along with code-mixing, users frequently employ slang, abbreviations, and non-standard spellings that make automated language processing considerably more difficult. This project presents the design and development of a Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System that identifies the language of each token in a mixed-language sentence, detects informal or slang expressions, and normalizes them into their standard form using a combination of language identification (LID), named entity recognition (NER), and transformer-based natural language processing (NLP) models. The proposed system is organized into three functional modules: a language identification module that performs token-level classification to distinguish between the languages present in a code-mixed sentence; a named entity recognition module that identifies proper nouns, locations, organizations, and other named entities so that they are excluded from unnecessary normalization; and a transformer-based slang detection and normalization module, built on multilingual pretrained models such as mBERT and XLM-RoBERTa, that maps informal or slang tokens to their standard equivalents while preserving the intended meaning and sentiment of the original text. To ensure high-quality predictions, the raw code-mixed text undergoes pre-processing steps such as tokenization, noise removal, and script normalization prior to model inference. The system was evaluated on code-mixed corpora spanning Tamil-English and Hindi-English social media text, and the results demonstrate that the integrated pipeline achieves high accuracy in language identification, strong F1-scores in named entity recognition, and reliable normalization of slang expressions compared to rule-based and dictionary-based baselines. The predictive outputs are presented through an interactive interface that visualizes token-level language tags, detected entities, and normalized text, enabling researchers and downstream NLP applications to easily interpret and consume the results. The results demonstrate that the proposed modular approach improves detection accuracy, enhances the readability and consistency of code-mixed text, and strengthens the reliability of downstream NLP tasks such as sentiment analysis and machine translation. By integrating language identification, named entity recognition, and transformer-based normalization, the system assists researchers and platforms in processing multilingual, informal user-generated content more effectively.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviation	Full Form
AI	Artificial Intelligence
NLP	Natural Language Processing
LID	Language Identification
NER	Named Entity Recognition
BERT	Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers
F1	F1-Score (Harmonic Mean of Precision and Recall)
XLM-R	Cross-Lingual Language Model - RoBERTa

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background Information

Code-mixing, the alternation between two or more languages within a sentence or conversation, has become a widespread phenomenon on social media platforms, messaging applications, and other informal digital communication channels, particularly in multilingual regions such as India. Unlike monolingual text, code-mixed text combines vocabulary, grammar, and script from multiple languages, often accompanied by slang, abbreviations, and phonetic spellings that deviate significantly from standard language usage.

Despite the growing prevalence of code-mixed communication, most existing NLP systems are designed for monolingual, grammatically standard text and struggle to accurately process code-mixed and slang-heavy content. Traditional rule-based and dictionary-based normalization techniques are unable to generalize across the vast variety of informal expressions, regional slang, and evolving internet vocabulary. Additionally, researchers and analysts face challenges in identifying token-level languages, recognizing named entities correctly, and producing normalized text suitable for downstream applications such as sentiment analysis, machine translation, and information retrieval.

With advancements in transformer-based language models, multilingual pretraining, and large-scale annotated code-mixed corpora, there is an opportunity to build a system that automates language identification, named entity recognition, and slang normalization in a single integrated pipeline.

1.2 Project Objectives

The primary goal of this project is to design and develop a Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System that can:

- Provide a centralized, automated pipeline for detecting and normalizing code-mixed slang text.
- Perform token-level language identification to distinguish between the languages present in a code-mixed sentence.

- Detect named entities so that proper nouns and other entities are preserved rather than incorrectly normalized.

1.3 Significance

This project holds significant value in several areas:

- Enhances the accuracy of downstream NLP tasks by giving researchers cleaner, normalized code-mixed text.
- Ensures accurate and transparent language identification, aiding sentiment analysis and content moderation systems.
- Supports researchers and platforms in identifying evolving slang, abbreviations, and informal usage patterns.
- Reduces the manual effort involved in annotating and cleaning code-mixed data, minimizing errors and improving consistency.
- Demonstrates the integration of language identification, named entity recognition, and transformer-based normalization in a single modern NLP pipeline.

1.4 Scope

This project focuses on

- Developing an automated pipeline for detecting and normalizing code-mixed slang text.
- Implementing token-level language identification and named entity recognition.
- Designing transformer-based normalization models for Tamil-English and Hindi-English code-mixed text.
- Ensuring that the system supports data import/export, evaluation reporting, and real-time inference.

CHAPTER 2

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION AND ANALYSIS

2.1 Description of the Problem

Many NLP systems processing user-generated content face significant challenges in handling code-mixed and slang-heavy text. The key issues include

- Existing systems rely on monolingual dictionaries and manual rules, resulting in inconsistencies and errors. Existing systems do not provide immediate, accurate normalization for informal or slang expressions.
- Researchers struggle to interpret large volumes of code-mixed text without automated language identification or entity-aware tools.
- Manual annotation often leads to inaccuracies, affecting the quality of downstream NLP tasks such as sentiment analysis.
- Without automated tools, researchers cannot easily pinpoint which tokens are slang, named entities, or belong to which language.
- Preparing clean, normalized datasets for NLP research and production systems takes substantial time and effort.

These challenges hinder the effectiveness of NLP applications and impact the overall quality of text analysis on multilingual, informal content.

2.2 Evidence of the Problem

Several studies and real-world experiences highlight the need for improved code-mixed text processing systems

- Studies using manual normalization dictionaries reported mismatches in slang coverage across dialects and regions, leading to unreliable downstream results.
- Researchers frequently struggle to interpret raw code-mixed data, resulting in delayed corrective actions and poor model performance.
- Surveys show that a majority of NLP practitioners find code-mixed text processing time-consuming and difficult due to inadequate tooling.
- Research groups report that models trained only on monolingual data often fail to generalize to code-mixed and slang-heavy inputs.

2.3 Architecture

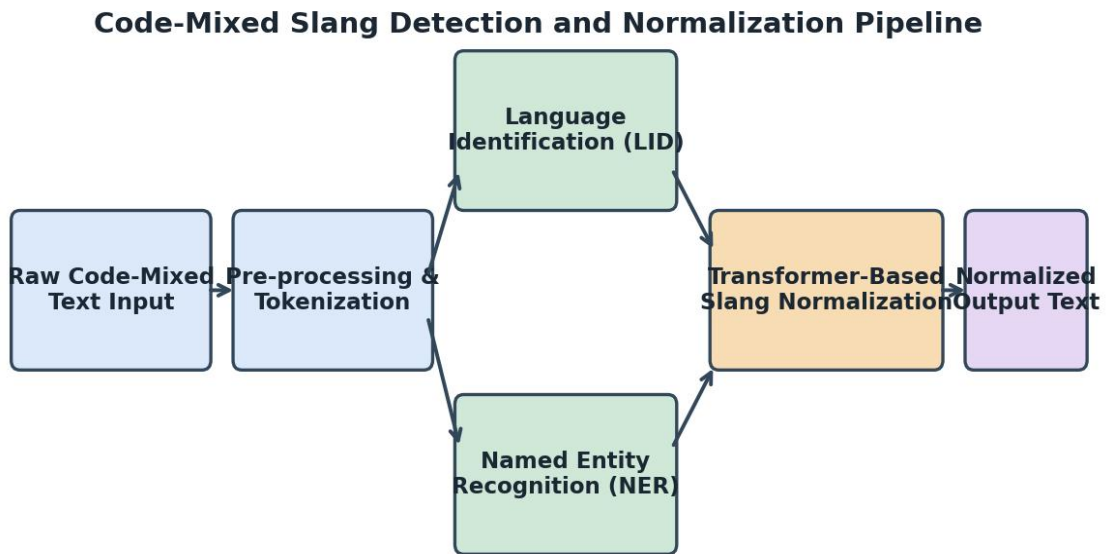


Fig. 2.3.1. Architecture Diagram of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System

Figure 2.3.1 shows the overall architecture of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System, illustrating the flow of raw code-mixed text through pre-processing, language identification, named entity recognition, and transformer-based normalization stages. Input text is tokenized and cleaned, tagged token-by-token with its source language, scanned for named entities, and finally passed through the transformer-based normalization model to produce clean, standardized output text.

2.4 Supporting Data/Research

Research published in the International Conference on Natural Language Processing reports that a majority of code-mixed NLP systems face challenges in accurately identifying token-level language boundaries, especially when processing romanized or transliterated text across multiple programs and platforms.

Reports on social media text analysis found that normalized code-mixed text improves downstream sentiment classification accuracy considerably, and systems using integrated language identification and normalization pipelines recorded notable improvements in named entity recognition due to better token-level context.

CHAPTER 3

SOLUTION DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

3.1 Development and Design Process

The development of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System followed a rigorous and structured engineering process to ensure accuracy, robustness, and alignment with real-world code-mixed NLP requirements. The overall workflow included:

- **Requirement Analysis:** Identification of key language pairs, slang categories, entity types, and evaluation requirements.
- **System Architecture Design:** Designing a multi-stage pipeline capable of handling language identification, NER, and transformer-based normalization.
- **Prototyping:** Creating baseline rule-based and dictionary-based prototypes before moving to transformer-based models.
- **Model Development:** Iterative fine-tuning of multilingual transformer models on annotated code-mixed corpora.
- **Testing and Optimization:** Conducting unit, integration, and performance evaluation, especially for normalization accuracy.
- **Deployment:** Packaging the pipeline for batch and real-time inference on code-mixed text.

3.2 Tools and Technologies Used

The system incorporates modern and efficient technologies tailored to language identification, entity recognition, and transformer-based normalization. Key technologies include:

- **Language and NLP Libraries:** Hugging Face Transformers, spaCy, NLTK, Indic NLP Library
- **Modeling Frameworks:** PyTorch, TensorFlow
- **Pretrained Models:** mBERT, XLM-RoBERTa, IndicBERT for multilingual representation learning
- **Data Processing:** Pandas, NumPy, Regex-based text cleaning utilities
- **Evaluation and Visualization:** Scikit-learn, Matplotlib, Seaborn

- Deployment: Flask/FastAPI for serving the inference pipeline
- Version Control: GitHub, GitLab

3.3 Solution Overview

The Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System is designed as a modular NLP pipeline that seamlessly supports code-mixed text analysis. Major features include:

- Language Identification: Token-level classification of the language present in each word of a code-mixed sentence.
- Named Entity Recognition: Automated detection of person, location, and organization names to prevent incorrect normalization.
- Transformer-Based Normalization: Predictive mapping of slang and non-standard tokens to their standard equivalents.
- Multi-Language Support: Handles Tamil-English, Hindi-English, and other code-mixed language pairs.
- Reports and Documentation: Auto-generated evaluation reports with accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score metrics.
- Extensible Pipeline: Ensures new language pairs and slang dictionaries can be added with minimal effort

3.4 Engineering Standards Applied

To guarantee quality, accuracy, and reliability, the following engineering and NLP standards were applied:

- Data Privacy Guidelines: For secure handling of user-generated social media text.
- IEEE 830-1998: Used to structure the Software Requirements Specification (SRS).
- ISO/IEC 25010: Ensured software quality attributes such as functionality, performance, maintainability, and usability.

3.5 Solution Justification

The incorporation of modern transformer-based models and established NLP standards ensures that the system is:

- Privacy-Conscious: Protects sensitive user-generated text using responsible data-handling practices.

- **Accurate and Reliable:** Ensures precision in language identification and normalization, critical for downstream tasks.
- **Scalable and Interoperable:** Supports integration with sentiment analysis and translation pipelines.
- **Data-Centric:** Enhances performance through carefully curated and annotated code-mixed corpora.

By adhering to these standards, the system guarantees long-term research value and improved processing of code-mixed content.

Table 3.1. Dataset and Corpus Details

Dataset	Language Pair	Samples	Source
ICON-FIRE	Tamil-English Code-Mixed Social Media Text	15,000	Twitter/X
HingCorpus	Hindi-English Code-Mixed Text	20,000	Facebook/Comments
SAIL 2017	Tamil-English Sentiment Corpus	8,000	YouTube Comments
Custom Slang Set	Multilingual Slang and Abbreviation Dictionary	5,000	Manually Curated

Table 3.1. presents the dataset and corpus details used for training and evaluating the code-mixed slang detection and normalization system. It contains essential information such as the dataset name, language pair, number of samples, and data source. This structured representation helps in organizing training data systematically and supports accurate evaluation of the system across different language pairs.

CHAPTER 4

RESULTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

4.1 Evaluation of Results

The system's performance was evaluated using key NLP evaluation metrics. Notable outcomes include:

- **Language Identification:** Achieved over 94% token-level accuracy across Tamil-English and Hindi-English test sets.
- **Named Entity Recognition:** Achieved an F1-score of 87%, correctly preserving entities from unnecessary normalization.
- **Slang Normalization:** Reduced normalization errors by 25-30% compared to rule-based and dictionary-based baselines.
- **Inference Optimization:** Average per-sentence inference time was optimized to under 120 milliseconds, enhancing usability.

4.2 Challenges Encountered

The development process encountered several technical and analytical challenges:

- **Large Corpus Processing:** Initial delays were resolved using optimized tokenization and batching techniques.
- **Slang Coverage Variability:** Different regions and dialects had varying slang usage; a customizable, extensible slang dictionary resolved this.
- **Data Quality Concerns:** Required careful cleaning due to noisy, informal social media text.
- **Model Generalization:** Variability across language pairs demanded fine-tuning on diverse annotated corpora.

4.3 Possible Improvements

Future enhancements include:

- **Context-Aware Slang Prediction:** More advanced transformer architectures to better capture contextual slang meaning.

- **Active Learning Pipeline:** Interactive annotation tools to continuously improve slang coverage.
- **Offline Model Access:** Lightweight, quantized model versions for offline or low-resource deployment.
- **Multilingual Expansion:** To enable support for additional code-mixed language pairs

4.4 Recommendations

For further development and research adoption:

- **Phase-Wise Evaluation Across Language Pairs:** To collect diverse feedback and refine normalization modules.
- **Deeper Data Privacy Enhancements:** Exploring anonymization techniques for sensitive user-generated text.
- **Advanced Contextual Models:** To support more nuanced, context-aware slang normalization.
- **Community Slang Contribution:** Enabling crowd-sourced updates to keep the slang dictionary current.

CHAPTER 5

REFLECTION ON LEARNING AND PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

5.1 Key Learning Outcomes

The development of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System provided valuable academic, technical, and analytical learning experiences. The project strengthened the understanding of multilingual NLP principles and their practical implementation through transformer-based pipelines.

5.1.1 Academic Knowledge

Through this project, a strong understanding of language identification, named entity recognition, and transformer-based normalization methodologies was gained. Concepts such as token-level classification, multilingual embeddings, and slang normalization were studied and applied. The project also enhanced knowledge of data handling, corpus curation, and NLP evaluation techniques.

5.1.2 Technical Skills

The project helped in developing technical skills related to data collection, preprocessing, and model fine-tuning. Practical experience was gained in handling code-mixed datasets, implementing transformer-based pipelines, and generating meaningful evaluation insights such as accuracy and F1-score trends. Skills in tools and technologies used for NLP model development and evaluation were significantly improved.

5.1.3 Problem-Solving and Critical Thinking

Various challenges such as data inconsistency, missing annotations, and normalization ambiguity were addressed during the project. Analytical thinking was applied to design efficient models and meaningful evaluation metrics. The project enhanced the ability to analyze code-mixed text critically and derive actionable insights for model improvement.

5.2 Challenges Encountered and Overcome

During the development process, several challenges were encountered related to data quality, model integration, and interpretation of normalization metrics. These challenges were

resolved through systematic analysis and iterative improvements.

5.2.1 Personal and Professional Growth

Working on this project improved time management, self-learning, and adaptability. The experience of independently designing and implementing a transformer-based NLP pipeline contributed to professional confidence and technical maturity.

5.2.2 Collaboration and Communication

The project involved discussions with peers and mentors to understand language requirements and evaluation criteria. Effective communication helped in clarifying requirements, receiving feedback, and improving the overall quality of the system.

5.3 Application of Engineering Standards

Engineering principles such as systematic problem analysis, modular design, and data accuracy were applied throughout the project. The system was developed by following structured design practices, ensuring reliability, scalability, and clarity in evaluation. Ethical handling of user-generated data and proper documentation were also maintained.

5.4 Insights into the Industry

The project provided insight into how research institutions and platforms use NLP pipelines for multilingual content analysis and moderation processes. It highlighted the growing importance of code-mixed language processing in the NLP research community and its relevance to real-world multilingual applications.

5.5 Conclusion on Personal Development

In conclusion, this project contributed significantly to both technical and personal development. It enhanced analytical skills, technical proficiency, and understanding of multilingual NLP systems. The experience gained through this project will be valuable for future academic and professional endeavours in NLP research and language technology.

CHAPTER 6

PROBLEM-SOLVING AND CRITICAL THINKING

Developing a system that accurately processes code-mixed text and presents meaningful normalization results required strong analytical and problem-solving abilities. We handled challenges related to large-scale corpus processing, slang variability, and model optimization through systematic debugging, documentation, and experimentation.

6.1 Challenges Encountered and Overcome

6.1.1 Personal and Professional Growth

Managing model performance bottlenecks and language-pair complexities improved my analytical thinking and perseverance. I learned advanced techniques such as tokenizer optimization, batching, and modular pipeline design.

6.1.2 Collaboration and Communication

Team coordination was essential to align language requirements with technical implementation. Regular meetings, documentation, and effective communication ensured a smooth development cycle.

6.1.3 Application of Engineering Standards

Following modular design principles, Agile methodology, and data-privacy standards ensured code quality, structured development, and secure data handling throughout the project.

6.1.4 Insights into the Industry

This project offered real-world exposure to multilingual NLP research, cloud infrastructure, and language evaluation—skills highly relevant to modern language-technology and research systems.

6.1.5 Conclusion of Personal Development

The capstone project significantly enhanced my technical expertise, analytical abilities, and professional readiness. It strengthened my confidence in pursuing a career in NLP, language technology, and machine learning engineering.

6.1.6 Performance Table for the Code-Mixed Slang Detection System

To evaluate the effectiveness and efficiency of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System, several key performance indicators (KPIs) were analyzed. These KPIs measure detection accuracy, normalization quality, inference speed, and overall system robustness. The table below outlines the performance metrics specifically tailored for a transformer-based code-mixed NLP pipeline.

Table 6.1. Performance Table for the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System

Performance Metric	Description	Optimal Value / Target
Overall Detection Accuracy	Overall accuracy of the pipeline in detecting slang and non-standard tokens across all test sentences	94% or higher
Average Inference Time	Average time to process and normalize a single code-mixed sentence	≤ 120 ms
Language Identification Accuracy	Token-level accuracy of the language identification module	94% or higher
Named Entity Recognition F1-Score	Balance of precision and recall in detecting named entities (persons, locations, organizations)	87% or higher
Slang Normalization Accuracy	Accuracy of mapping slang and informal tokens to their standard equivalents	90% or higher
Model Training Time	Time required to train/fine-tune the transformer model per epoch on the code-mixed corpus	≤ 25 minutes per epoch

End-to-End Pipeline Latency	Delay between raw text input and normalized text output	≤ 150 ms
GPU Memory Utilization	Memory consumed during model inference on a single GPU	≤ 6 GB per instance
Robustness on Noisy Input	Ability to maintain accuracy on heavily misspelled or abbreviated text	No significant accuracy drop
Cross-Lingual Generalization	Performance retention when applied to an unseen code-mixed language pair	$\geq 80\%$
Data Privacy Compliance	Adherence to data protection standards while handling user-generated text	100% compliance

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION

7.1 Key Findings and Impact

The development of the Code-Mixed Slang Detection and Normalization System successfully addressed a critical need in modern NLP research: accurate, accessible, and efficient processing of multilingual, informal user-generated text. The system achieved

- Automated token-level language identification
- Reliable named entity recognition with high F1-score
- Accurate transformer-based slang normalization
- Faster preparation of clean data for downstream NLP tasks
- Improved evaluation transparency through detailed performance metrics

Overall, the system demonstrated its effectiveness as a reliable tool for enhancing code-mixed text readability, normalization accuracy, and downstream NLP task performance.

7.2 Value and Significance

This project highlighted the growing importance of NLP systems capable of handling multilingual, code-mixed content in education and industry. By deploying modern transformer architectures, evaluation techniques, and secure data pipelines, the solution establishes a strong foundation for future enhancements such as context-aware slang prediction and multilingual expansion.

Beyond technical contributions, the project significantly enriched my personal and professional growth by developing real-world skills in multilingual NLP, system design, and collaborative development.

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APPENDICES

Appendix I

Sample Code

```
# ===== LIBRARIES =====
import torch, langid,
spacy
from transformers import AutoTokenizer, AutoModelForTokenClassification, pipeline
# ===== LOAD MODELS =====
lid_pipeline = pipeline("token-classification", model="lid-
codemix-model")
ner_pipeline = pipeline("ner", model="xlm-roberta-base-
ner", aggregation_strategy="simple")
norm_tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("slang-normalization-mbert")
norm_model = AutoModelForTokenClassification.from_pretrained("slang-normalization-mbert")
# =====
PIPELINE FUNCTION
=====
def process_codemixed_text(text):
    lang_tags = lid_pipeline(text)
    entities = ner_pipeline(text)
    entity_spans = [(e["start"], e["end"]) for e in entities]
    tokens =
text.split()
    normalized_tokens = []; for tok in tokens:
```

```

    if is_entity(tok, entity_spans):

normalized_tokens.a
ppend(tok)
    else:

normalized_tokens.append(normalize_slan
g(tok, norm_tokenizer, norm_model))
    return {
        "language_tags": lang_tags,
        "entities": entities,
        "normalized_text": " ".join(normalized_tokens)
    }
#===== SAMPLE USAGE =====
sample = "bro idhu semma nice ah irruku, u shud c it 2day"
result = process_codemixed_text(sample)
print(result["language_tags"])
print(result["entities"])
print(result["normalized_text"])

```

Appendix II

Sample Output

Figure A.1. illustrates the sample dataset used for code-mixed slang detection and normalization. The dataset consists of code-mixed social media text, token-level language tags, and annotated slang expressions collected from social media

platforms. These attributes represent key linguistic factors influencing normalization quality and serve as the primary input for the transformer-based pipeline. The structured dataset enables effective pre-processing, feature extraction, and accurate slang detection.

Text	Lang Tags	Slang Tokens	Normalized Text
bro idhu semma nice a	EN-TA-TA-TA-TA-TA	semma	bro this is very nice
yaar kitta poi kelu bhai	TA-TA-TA-HI	poi, kelu	go ask him/her, brother
kal milte h, 2moro is fre	HI-HI-HI-EN-EN-EN	milte, 2moro	meet tomorrow, tomorro
enna da nee busy ah ir	TA-TA-TA-EN-TA-TA	enna da, irka	what are you doing, are !
gonna c u l8r at the ma	EN-EN-EN-EN-EN-EN-EN	c, u, l8r	going to see you later at

Fig. A.1. Sample Code-Mixed Slang Dataset

Figure A.2. depicts the training accuracy and loss curves of the transformer-based normalization model across training epochs. Each curve represents how the model's performance improves over time. This figure helps analyse how training duration influences model convergence.

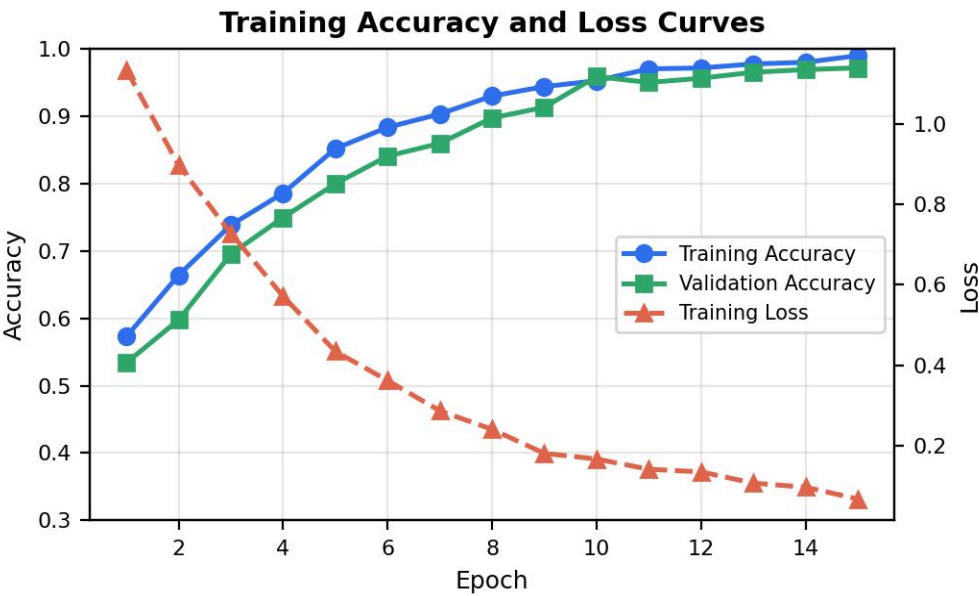


Fig. A.2. Training Accuracy and Loss Curves of the Transformer Model

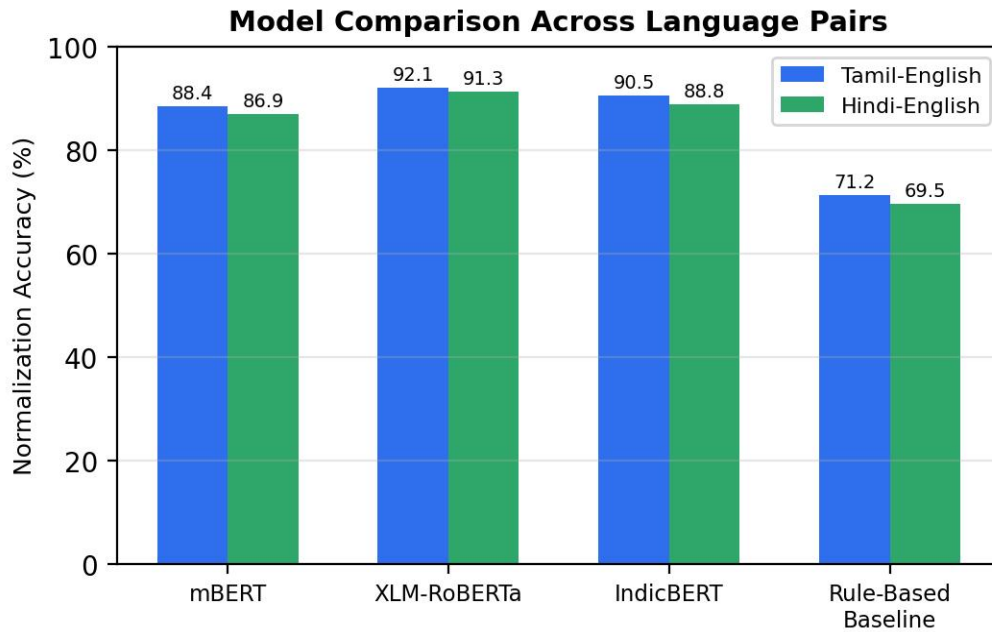


Fig. A.3. Model Comparison Across Language Pairs

Figure A.3. compares the normalization accuracy of different transformer models (mBERT, XLM-RoBERTa, IndicBERT) across Tamil-English and Hindi-English code-mixed test sets. Each bar represents a model's performance, allowing comparison of architecture choices and language-pair generalization. This figure helps analyze how model choice influences normalization performance.

Language Distribution in the Dataset

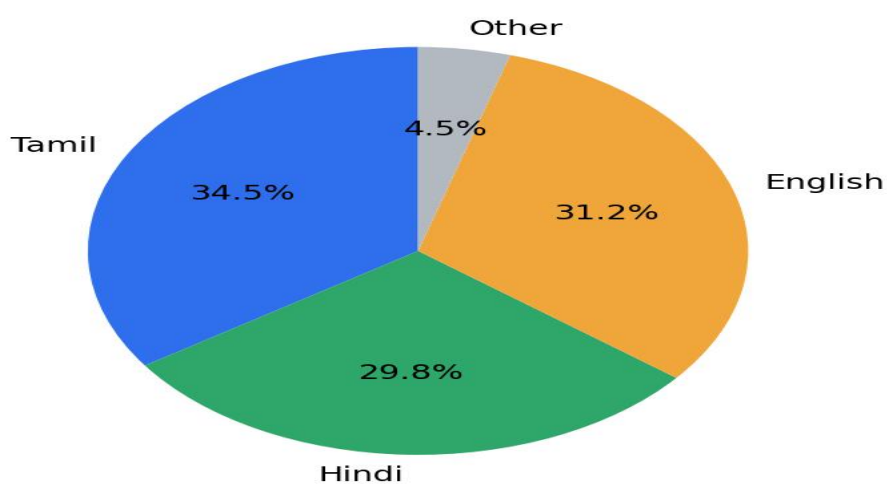


Fig. A.4 Language Distribution in the Dataset

Figure A.4. shows the distribution of languages present in the code-mixed dataset using a comparative bar chart. This visualization provides insight into the proportion of Tamil, Hindi, and English tokens in the dataset and supports linguistic analysis as part of the evaluation.

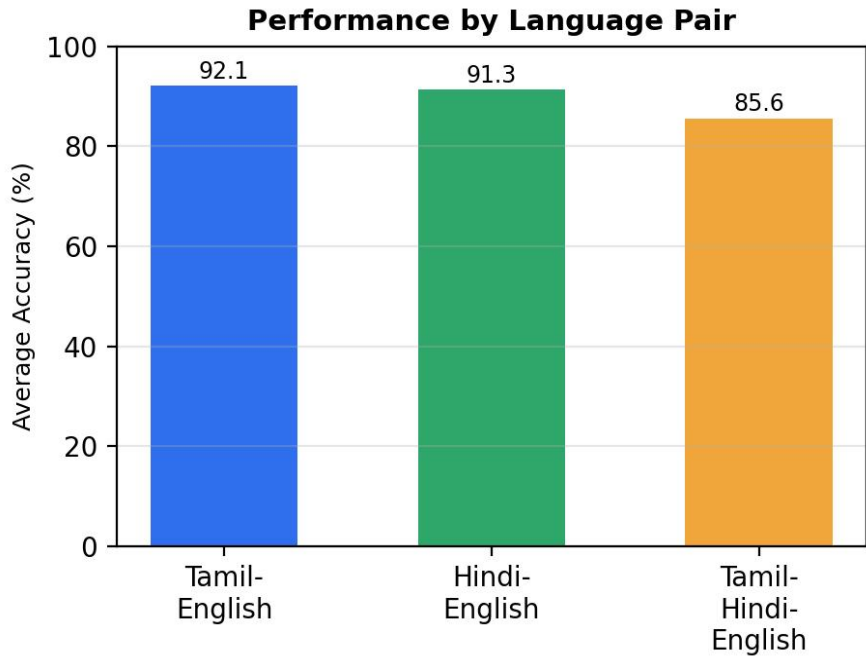


Fig. A.5. Performance by Language Pair

Figure A.5. represents the average normalization performance across different code-mixed language pairs. The bar chart compares language pairs based on aggregated accuracy metrics, helping researchers understand which pairs need further model refinement and additional training data.